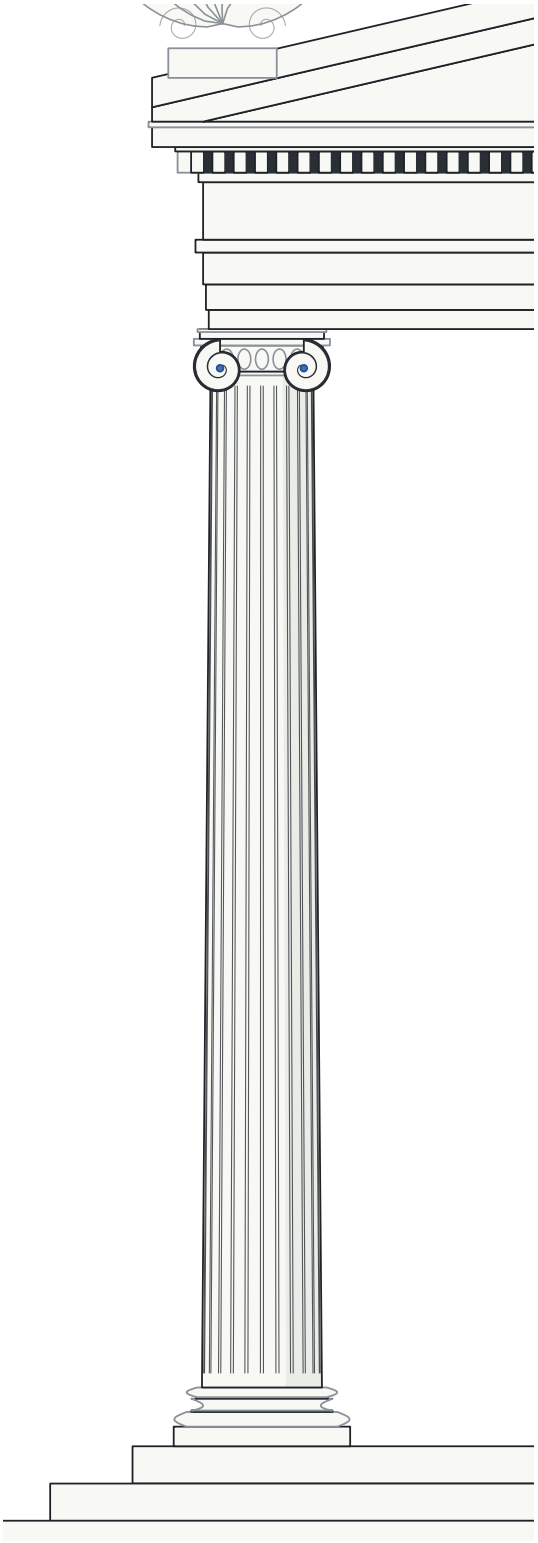
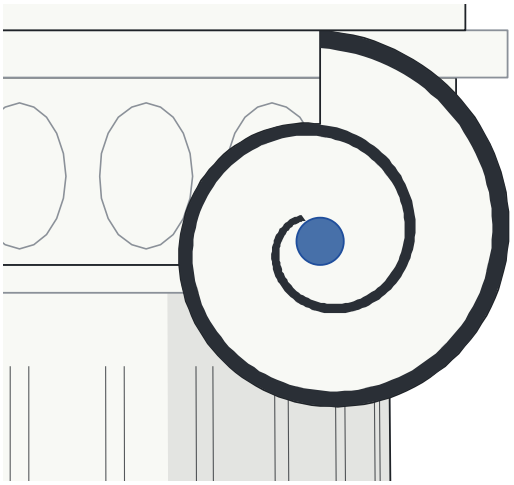
eye of the volute

Ionic · Latin study. Blue identifies the selected part.



Whole plate. Geometry and grey drawing choices are those of the workshop.



Local crop at 2× its initial local zoom. This enlarges the same geometry and can show only a portion of a long feature; no carving detail is added.

eye of the volute

ocvlvs Latin

eye

Vitruvius III.5.6

ὀφθαλμοί ophthalmoi Greek

eyes; in the building accounts, the discs at the centres of the volutes

LSJ s.v. ὀφθαλμός (IG I² 374)

Read the word in a phrase

centrvm ocvli

the centre of the eye

Oculus names the eye. Here oculi is genitive singular: ‘of the eye’. The ending tells you whose centre is being placed in the Ionic-capital description.

From Vitruvius III.5.5–6, Krohn 1912, p. 71. Reading note and English are modern.

One of the volute's eight parts across. Athenian builders and the Roman writer both called it an eye.

Vitruvius III.5.5–6

qvam crassvs imvs scapvs fverit addita octava decvma parte scapi, abacvs habeat longitvdinem et latitvdinem; crassitvdinem cvm volvtis eivs dimidiam … tvnc crassitvdo dividenda est in partes novem et dimidiam … tvnc ex novem partibvs et dimidia vna pars et dimidia abaci crassitvdo relinqvatvr, reliqvae octo volvtis constitvantvr … vt qvattvor partes et dimidia svb abaco relinqvantvr … centrvm ocvli ⟨conlocetvr⟩ … tam magna in diametro, qvam vna pars ex octo partibvs est.

The abacus is as long and wide as the bottom of the shaft plus an eighteenth; its height with the volutes, half of that … divide the height into nine and a half parts: one and a half for the thickness of the abacus, the other eight for the volutes … leaving four and a half parts below the abacus, set the centre of the eye … a circle with a diameter of one of the eight parts.

Krohn 1912, p. 71

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F. Krohn's 1912 Teubner Vitruvius, complete printed page 71, including the critical apparatus. Public domain. Original scan.

uti, quam crassus imus scapus fuerit addita octava decuma parte scapi, abacus habeat longitudinem et latitudinem; crassitudinem cum volutis eius dimidiam. recedendum autem est ab extremo abaco iu interiorem partem frontibus volutarum parte duodevicensima et eius dimidia. tunc crassitudo dividenda est in partes novem et dimidiam, et secundum abacum in quattuor partibus volutarum secundum extremi abaci quadram lineae demittendae, quae cathetoe dicuntur. tunc ex novem partibus et dimidia una pars et dimidia abaci crassitudo relinquatur, reliquae octo volutis constituantur. tunc ab linea, quae secundum abaci 6
extremam partem demissa erit, in interiorem partem ⟨alia⟩
79 recedat unius et dimidiatae partis latitudine. deinde hae lineae dividantur ita, ut quattuor partes et dimidia sub abaco relinquantur. tunc in eo loco, qui locus dividit quattuor et dimidiam et tres et dimidiam partem, centrum oculi ⟨conlocetur⟩ signeturque ex eo centro rotunda circinatio tam magna in diametro, quam una pars ex octo partibus est. ea erit oculi magnitudine, et in ea catheto respondens diametros agatur. tunc ab summo sub abaco inceptum ⟨schema volutae⟩ in singulis tetrantorum actionibus dimidiatum oculi spatium minuatur, doneque in eundem tetrantem, qui subest, conveniat. capituli autem 7
crassitudo sic est facienda, ut ex novem partibus et dimidia tres partes praependeant infra astragalum summi scapi; cymatio, adempto abaco et canali, reliqua sit pars. proiectura autem cymatii habeat extra abaci quadram oculi magnitudinem. pulvinorum baltei ab abaco hanc habe-

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1 octava decuma *HS*: nona decima *G* 2 parte *G*: partem *HS* 8 dimittendae *x* 12 demissa *G*^{c}: dimissa *x* *add. Joc* 15 relinquantur *G*: -quatur *HS* 17 conlocetur *add. Kr* (signetur ducaturque *Joc*) 19 catheto *Joc*: catheton *S*, cathecton *HG* 21 *add. Kr* (*cf. 66, 4; 136, 1 etc.*) 22 doneque (donique *Lachm*): denique *x* 23 qui subest, conveniat *Kr*: qui est sub abconveniat (*H*, subaco veniat *G*, sub abaco veniat *S*) *x* 26 adempto *ed*: adepto *x* 27 habet *H et a. c. S* 28 ab *G*: *om. HS*

Reading and model boundaries

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